

to both control their own technology path as well as avoid lock-in with a vendor or a set of vendors.

Q. How do you think India is performing in the open source space right now?

With the democratisation of technologies such as cloud, and AI/ML now fairly mature, open source has become much more viable and mainstream today, and India is on the right track for scaling open source adoption.

Q. As you are a tech leader, what kind of innovations can we see from Oracle in the very near future?

Oracle is known for its strong focus on innovation via consistent, sizable R&D investments and efforts. Like I mentioned earlier, our flagship innovation in recent times – the Oracle Autonomous Database – is a generational innovation. It's the world's first and only self-driving, self-securing and self-repairing database.

We will continue to innovate, with customer-centricity in mind, and we will work closely with our customers and partners, while keeping an eye on the market trends.

Q. What do you think is more important – innovations or continuous improvement?

Why should you pick one over the other, when you can do both in parallel? I believe both are equally important to marry an organisation's short term priorities with long term growth objectives. And today, technology makes it possible.

Q. In terms of hiring, what do you think are the must-have skillsets for techies right now?

If anything, 2020 has taught organisations to improve agility and business resilience, because of the unprecedented situation globally. What we are seeing is increased proliferation of some of the most promising technologies, with more commercial success. AI/

ML continues to be a huge area of opportunities, because I truly believe the industry has barely scratched the surface of possibilities. Edge computing is expected to be the next big opportunity. And technology paradigms such as blockchain and chatbots will further evolve and be in vogue at least for the next decade or two.

Technology practitioners are in a unique position to shape much of how the world lives and transacts in the new decade, so it's going to be a super exciting and equally challenging era for software, with developers truly becoming the kings, as the saying goes in the technology world. Techies looking to deepen their expertise in some of the above mentioned areas, as well as data science and analytics, will continue to be sought after. Further, given the dynamic cyber security landscape and shortage of quality cyber security talent, it's going to be an alluring career option as well.

Q. Java has completed 25 years of service to the industry. What, according to you, is its most significant achievement and why?

Java has an unparalleled legacy in the developer world. Its massive following globally in the developer community is testimony to how much Java has impacted our lives as individuals and organisations. From helping remotely control the Mars Rover in 2004, to helping teach kids programming on Minecraft in 2020, Java has consistently been the world's most popular and loved programming language, and we are really grateful to the vast number of influencers and champions in the Java community for this.

Q. With so many languages gaining popularity, do you still suggest developers should build their career around Java?

Absolutely. It's been 25 years of innovation, and yet Java continues to be the world's #1 programming language, with over 69 per cent of

full-time developers using it globally. Today, Java has emerged as a preferred language for development spanning a number of technology paradigms – from DevOps to AI/ML, AR/VR to Big Data and analytics, continuous integration to mobile and chatbots, amongst others. For microservices, too, Java is the preferred development language. We're consistently focusing on R&D at any given time during the year to make Java even faster, younger and much more reliable. In the last couple of years, we have moved to a six-month cadence for new releases for Java, with an eye on empowering the developer community with speedier innovations, far greater predictability and, of course, greater stability.

Q. Are there any innovations in recent releases of Java or is there anything new that developers should be looking up to in 2021?

As part of our most recent six-month release, we have made available Java 15 with new feature additions to help developers improve their productivity and application security. This latest release has been a result of industry-wide development that spanned open reviews, weekly builds as well as deep collaboration between Oracle engineers with members of the global Java developer community, via the Java Community Process in addition to the OpenJDK Community.

Q. As a tech leader, what are the leadership mantras you swear by?

Both as an organisation for Oracle, as well as for me at a personal level, customer-centricity is the key. Our world revolves around customers, and every employee is responsible for helping our customers solve their complex business problems, to better serve their end customers. Ultimately, it's imperative to develop into a trusted advisor for each and every customer. 

Note: The complete interview can be read at <https://www.opensourceforu.com/>.